Era 2: Contact & Colonization

1491–1607 · APUSH Period 1 · Lessons 2–2

Name _____ Due _____

This is your study guide for the whole era. Complete each lesson section as you study it, using your class notes and textbook: read the AP topic(s) listed for the lesson in your textbook, define every term, person and event in your own words, then answer the Key Question in 3–5 sentences with specific evidence. Each lesson is checked and stamped in class; the whole guide is collected and graded at the end of the era. **Before the end-of-era test:** finish the Era Wrap-Up, then reread the whole guide. Fix or add anything in a different color.

Lesson 2 *Exploration · Columbian Exchange · Spanish empire*

1.3 (LO C): Explain the causes of exploration and conquest of the New World by various European nations.
1.4 (LO D): Explain the causes of the Columbian Exchange and its effect on Europe and the Americas over time.
1.5 (LO E): Explain how the growth of the Spanish Empire shaped the development of social and economic structures over time.

Read (AP topics in your textbook): Topic 1.3 *European Exploration in the Americas* · Topic 1.4 *Columbian Exchange, Spanish Exploration, and Conquest* · Topic 1.5 *Labor, Slavery, and Caste in the Spanish Colonial System*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

1. **Columbian Exchange**

2. **transatlantic slave trade**

3. **disease (smallpox, measles, chicken pox)**

4. **encomienda system**

5. **casta system**

6. **mission system**

7. **conquistadors**

8. **Black Legend**

9. **Requerimiento**

10. **peninsulares, creoles & mestizos**

11. **Potosí silver mines**

People

Who they were and why they matter.

12. **Christopher Columbus**

13. **Hernán Cortés**

14. **Francisco Pizarro**

15. **Bartolomé de las Casas**

16. **Sir Walter Raleigh**

17. **Juan Ginés de Sepúlveda**

Events

What happened and why it matters.

18. **Columbus's first voyage (1492)**

19. **Treaty of Tordesillas (1494)**

20. **conquest of the Aztecs (1519–21)**

21. **conquest of the Inca (1530s)**

22. **Valladolid Debate (1550–51)**

23. **"Lost Colony" of Roanoke (1587)**

Lesson 2 · Key Question *Exploration · Columbian Exchange · Spanish empire*

1.3 (LO C): Explain the causes of exploration and conquest of the New World by various European nations.
1.4 (LO D): Explain the causes of the Columbian Exchange and its effect on Europe and the Americas over time.
1.5 (LO E): Explain how the growth of the Spanish Empire shaped the development of social and economic structures over time.

Explain how the Columbian Exchange and the growth of the Spanish Empire transformed societies in the Americas, Europe, and Africa between 1492 and 1607.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Era Wrap-Up *complete before the end-of-era test*

The Columbian Exchange

Category	From the Americas to Europe & Africa	From Europe & Africa to the Americas	One major effect
Crops & foods			
Animals			
Diseases			
Labor & people			
Wealth (gold & silver)			

Building the Spanish Empire

System or idea	What it was	Effect on Native peoples or Africans
Encomienda system		
Mission system		
Casta system		
Transatlantic slave trade		
Valladolid Debate (Las Casas vs. Sepúlveda)		

AP Short-Answer Practice

Answer a, b and c. Each part is scored on its own, so answer each one directly in 1–3 sentences with specific historical evidence.

Bartolomé de las Casas, Spanish priest and former encomendero, A Short Account of the Destruction of the Indies (Seville, 1552), from an English translation printed in London in 1689

Now this infinite multitude of Men are by the Creation of God innocently simple, altogether void of and averse to all manner of Craft, Subtlety and Malice, and most Obedient and Loyal Subjects to their Native Sovereigns; and behave themselves very patiently, sumissively [sic] and quietly towards the Spaniards, to whom they are subservient and subject; so that finally they live without the least thirst after revenge, laying aside all litigiousness, Commotion and hatred.

[. . .]

The Spaniards first assaulted the innocent Sheep, so qualified by the Almighty, as is premention'd, like most cruel Tygers, Wolves and Lions hunger-starv'd, studying nothing, for the space of Forty Years, after their first landing, but the Massacre of these Wretches, whom they have so inhumanely and barbarously butcher'd and harass'd with several kinds of Torments, never before known, or heard (of which you shall have some account in the following Discourse) that of Three Millions of Persons, which lived in Hispaniola itself, there is at present but the inconsiderable remnant of scarce Three Hundred.

Text: Project Gutenberg, from the anonymous English translation printed in London in 1689. Excerpt; original spelling and capitalization.

a. Briefly describe Las Casas's point of view toward the Spanish treatment of Native peoples as expressed in the excerpt.

b. Briefly explain ONE cause of the decline of the Native population of the Caribbean other than the violence described in the excerpt.

c. Briefly explain ONE way Spanish labor systems in the Americas changed between 1492 and 1607.

DBQ Practice · Contextualization

PROMPT

Evaluate the extent to which Spanish colonization transformed American Indian societies from 1492 to 1607.

Your task: Write a contextualization paragraph (3–4 sentences) that you could use to open an essay on this prompt. You may use the document on this page as a reference.

What earns the point: To earn the point, describe a broader historical context relevant to the prompt: developments before, during, or continuing after 1492–1607 (for example, the Reconquista and Spain's search for wealth and converts, or Native societies before contact). Explain how that context connects to the topic; a single phrase or reference is not enough.

The Requerimiento ("Requirement"), written in 1513 by the Spanish jurist Juan López de Palacios Rubios; conquistadors were ordered to read it to Native peoples, demanding that they accept the authority of the Catholic Church and the Spanish monarchs

But, if you do not do this, and maliciously make delay in it, I certify to you that, with the help of God, we shall powerfully enter into your country, and shall make war against you in all ways and manners that we can, and shall subject you to the yoke and obedience of the Church and of their Highnesses; we shall take you and your wives and your children, and shall make slaves of them, and as such shall sell and dispose of them as their Highnesses may command; and we shall take away your goods, and shall do you all the mischief and damage that we can, as to vassals who do not obey, and refuse to receive their lord, and resist and contradict him; and we protest that the deaths and losses which shall accrue from this are your fault, and not that of their Highnesses, or ours, nor of these cavaliers who come with us.

Text: Encyclopedia Virginia (Virginia Humanities), English translation; the same translation appears at Teaching American History. Excerpt.

Connect forward — *Era 3 preview: Spain built its empire on conquest, silver, and coerced labor. As England, France, and the Netherlands colonize North America after 1607, compare their goals and their relations with Native peoples to Spain's.*